

Title :My Existence Is Like Illusion

Part I: A Name Without Substance

“My existence is like illusion—not quite vanishing, but never truly arriving.”

I often wonder if I exist in the way others claim to. People speak of themselves with such certainty.

“I am.”

Such a simple declaration. So full of weight.

But when I say those words, “I am,” they dissipate before the breath even cools in my lungs. It’s not that I doubt the pulse in my wrist or the warmth of my body, but rather... I question if any of it holds meaning beyond this moment—if it isn’t all just smoke performing the shape of something solid.

I walk through rooms like a ghost still waiting for permission to be seen. People pass me, eyes full of light and lists and longing. And I? I pass too. But not through space—through time, as if I were only the suggestion of a person. A sketch, half-erased. I wave, I smile, I answer when spoken to. Yet inside, there’s a hollow chamber echoing back every word I speak with a quiet:

“Are you sure you’re real?”

Sometimes I stand before the mirror and look into my own eyes until my face no longer feels like mine.

Who is that?

What thread ties that skin to the soul inside it?

Do I even have a soul? Or am I simply memory wrapped in skin?

There are days I forget how I arrived here. Not the physical here—not this apartment, this chair, this mug with chipped glaze. But the here of being. The now of identity. What series of accidents constructed this self I wear like a coat I didn’t choose? Somewhere along the way, I stopped growing into it. Now it hangs on me—loose, unsure, unwanted.

Maybe all of us are illusions. But most are good at pretending otherwise. They hold jobs, build homes, love people, fight for causes. They drape their illusion with rituals of permanence. I don’t. I can’t. The closer I get to certainty, the more it crumbles under my hands like ash.

I write this not for answers, but to trace the outline of my dissonance.

I exist, yes—but not like they do.

Not with rootedness.

Not with conviction.

More like a breeze wandering through borrowed rooms.

Part II: The Weightless Hours

Time is a soft liar.

It tells me it’s moving forward, but I can’t feel it. The days pass, yes—but more like water dripping in a dark cave. You hear the sound. You see the wet. But the pool never fills. Every hour I live feels like it’s borrowed from someone else’s story. Mine has long since run out of plot.

Morning, afternoon, night—they come and go without significance. I wake not because I slept, but because my body tires of stillness. I eat, not out of hunger, but because chewing gives my hands something to do. I don't remember the last time I tasted food with meaning. It's all texture now. A gesture of survival. Nothing more.

The sun crosses the sky like a stage light I can't feel. Sometimes I sit by the window just to confirm the world is still out there—that I didn't dream the trees and roads and faces. But even they blur sometimes, as if I'm watching reality through a layer of gauze.

Am I disappearing?

Or was I never here to begin with?

Part III: Rooms Without Walls

My apartment is small, but it echoes. I walk from one end to the other and hear my footsteps like a stranger's, trailing behind me with the hollow slap of something not quite touching the floor.

There are no photographs on my walls. No books arranged just so. No evidence of a person with history or habits. It's not that I hate those things—I simply forget to gather them. Or maybe I don't believe I deserve permanence.

Sometimes I envy clutter. A messy desk, a forgotten sock, a fridge full of things going bad—proof that someone lives here. My space is too clean. Too curated. Like a waiting room for someone who never arrives.

I once bought a plant. A small fern. I forgot to water it for two weeks and it shriveled like truth under interrogation. I didn't cry when it died. I simply whispered, "I know," and threw it away.

How can anything grow in illusion?

Part IV: Conversations with the Ceiling

At night, I talk to the ceiling.

Not aloud. Not always. But with the mind's mouth—the voice inside that never stops whispering, even when you beg it to rest.

I ask questions I don't expect answers to:

Do I matter?

If I vanished, would the world notice a lighter weight in the room?

Is there someone, somewhere, who dreams of me the way I once dreamed of being known?

The ceiling never answers. It just listens. And that's both comfort and curse. Because sometimes, I want silence to mean something. Sometimes, I want my emptiness to echo into a shape I can name.

They say we're made of stardust. That we carry the remnants of explosions across galaxies. But I feel more like I'm made of static. Like I flicker in and out. Here. Not here. Real. Not quite.

Part V: Mirrors Without Reflections

There are days I avoid mirrors. Not out of vanity, but fear. Fear that one day I'll look in and see nothing staring back.

I already feel like I'm fading. Slowly. Like ink in sunlight. Still legible, but only barely. And sometimes the person I see in the mirror isn't me. It's a version that learned how to mimic human movement. How to smile just enough. Nod just enough. Say "I'm fine" with the exact right intonation.

But it's not real. I'm not real.

I used to think I could fix myself. That if I worked hard enough, read enough, healed enough—I'd come back to life. But what if there's no self to return to? What if I was always just a shape others projected their needs into?

I think the worst part of illusion is this:

You're always surrounded by people.

And still, profoundly alone.

Part VI: Ghosts of the Future

When I was younger, I made plans. I saw a future filled with fire and color—books I'd write, cities I'd travel, love I'd live inside. That future is gone now. Or rather, it's too far to touch. Like a balloon cut loose, drifting into a sky I can't climb.

I still write lists sometimes. Just to pretend.

- Wake up early
- Drink water
- Answer emails
- Create something

But by midday, the paper remains unchecked, accusing. Another reminder that I'm pretending to be a person with momentum.

I don't dream like I used to. When I sleep now, I fall into a gray space. No light. No sound. Just floating. And when I wake, there's no aftertaste of dreams—just the same gray inside my chest.

Hope is a fragile machine. Once broken, you can keep replacing the parts, but it will never run the same.

Part VII: Paper Skin

Some days, I feel like my body is made of paper. Fragile, easily torn. The world brushes against me, and it leaves dents—little bruises that no one sees but me.

And yet, people call me strong.

It's funny, isn't it? How easy it is to perform resilience. To wear it like a mask while underneath, the bones of belief have already crumbled.

I laugh when expected. I say "it's okay" even when nothing is. I hold space for others even when mine is empty.

But I wonder—if I peeled away the layers, what would be left? Just pulp and silence?

Maybe that's what illusion truly is: the performance of being fine while drowning.

Part VIII: The Quiet Between Notes

There is a moment in music—between one note and the next—that feels more honest than the sound itself. It's the breath. The space. The anticipation of meaning.

That's what my life feels like now: a sustained pause, waiting for something that never arrives.

I sit on the edge of my bed, sometimes for hours, doing nothing. Not sad. Not happy. Not angry. Just... waiting. For what, I don't know. Maybe a sign. Maybe someone to knock and say, "There you are. I've been looking for you."

But no one comes. No one ever comes.

And so I continue. Moving not out of purpose, but inertia. Not because I believe in anything—but because the alternative feels too final.

Part IX: The Unsaid Things

There are things I've never told anyone. Words that live like dust beneath my ribs. They whisper in the dark and beg to be spoken, but I keep them hidden. Maybe because once they're out, I'll be even more invisible. Or maybe because they're all I have left.

I don't hate life. I don't wish for death.

I just... don't know what to do with this in-between.

This half-life.

This illusion of being.

There's a loneliness in knowing that even if someone asked me what's wrong, I wouldn't know how to answer. How do you explain that you feel like fog wearing a name?

How do you say, "I am here—but not quite,"

and expect them to understand?

Part X: Echoes in the Fog

I walk a lot these days. Not for exercise. Not for destination. Just to feel something move. My body, the air, the light. Movement reminds me that I still take up space. That I still exist, if only barely.

Sometimes, I see people smiling, holding hands, laughing at things I can't hear. They feel solid. Grounded. Real. And for a brief moment, I ache to be like them. To believe the illusion is not illusion at all—but life.

But it never lasts.

Because I know the truth:

I am here. But not rooted.

Alive. But not awake.

Seen. But not touched.

My existence is like illusion.

A shadow cast by a flame long extinguished.

A name whispered into fog,

Still waiting to become real.

Part XI: The Curtain of Noise

There's a sound I've grown used to—it lives somewhere behind the walls of my life. A distant humming, not unlike an old television left on in a locked room. It's the sound of everything continuing. The sound of streets bustling, trains rattling, lovers laughing in parks, pages turning in books I'll never read.

This noise isn't loud—it's constant. Like static under all things. It reminds me that the world moves with or without me. That life is not waiting. It isn't missing me. It doesn't notice I'm late.

I walk through this sound like a ghost through water. Everything touches me, but nothing wets my skin. I'm present in the shape of a man. A coat of bones held together by habit and memory. But I haven't felt in so long. Not deeply. Not sharply. Just glimmers. Illusions of joy that flicker out before I can name them.

I wonder if one day the curtain will fall completely. If the noise will stop and I will become truly, beautifully still.

But even that feels like a fantasy too large for me.

Part XII: The Museum of Others

There is a bench in a quiet part of town, near the edge of the river where the path curves just enough to hide you from both the bridge and the traffic. I sit there often. Watching.

People walk past me like stories I'll never read. A girl with a scarf trailing like a comet. A man chewing his lip as he scrolls on his phone. A couple sharing an umbrella in a rain too soft to matter.

They are a museum of lives I do not live.

I imagine who they are. What books they dog-ear. Who they text when they're afraid. What songs remind them of who they used to be. And as I do, I become no one. I dissolve into the art on the wall. Just another exhibit, unnoticed.

They say connection is the anchor of existence. That being known is being real. But I have conversations only with air and windows. The reflection nods back, but says nothing. The wind understands, but has no words.

I am a frame without a painting. A whisper mistaken for breath.

Part XIII: The Loneliness of Language

Words used to be my home. I carved myself into the page when I couldn't live in the world. But lately, even language feels foreign—like a country I'm no longer fluent in.

I speak, but everything feels mistranslated. Like I'm trying to describe fog using fire. There's no accuracy. No resonance. Only distance.

People ask, "How are you?" and I say, "I'm fine."

But inside I want to scream:

"I'm vanishing, don't you see? I'm here—but just barely!"

But even if I said that, they wouldn't understand. Because vanishing isn't visible. It doesn't bleed or bruise. It just quietly removes color from your days, joy from your mornings, sound from your laughter.

I write still, yes—but the words feel like placeholders. Like I'm trying to stitch together a soul from scraps. Maybe this is all writing really is: an act of begging to be real.

Part XIV: The Weight of Being Forgotten

It's easy to disappear when no one is looking for you.

There's a peculiar heaviness in knowing that if you left tomorrow, the world would continue exactly as it has. No shift. No ripple. Just the silence of your absence settling like dust over furniture.

I used to crave legacy. I wanted to matter. To make something so honest it outlived me. But now I just want to exist. To be seen while still breathing.

Even just once.

But I walk through rooms unnoticed. I type messages and delete them before sending. I scroll past the faces of people I once called friends and wonder how many of them would even recognize me now.

And sometimes, in my worst moments, I think... maybe this is all I deserve. Maybe I was meant to be a forgotten footnote in a book no one finishes.

Maybe my name was never mine to begin with.

Part XV: The Threadbare Moon

Tonight the moon hangs low and quiet, like it's tired too.

It casts its light not like a spotlight, but like a sigh. A dim confession that even celestial things grow weary. I sit beneath it, barefoot in the kitchen, cold tea in hand, and feel—for the first time in a long while—that maybe the illusion is not failure.

Maybe it's survival.

Maybe to live in illusion is to keep walking despite the hollowness. Maybe I'm still here not because I'm lost, but because I'm seeking.

What if the illusion of my existence is not absence—but a prelude?

A long pause before the music begins again.

I don't know. I may never know.

But I write these words like breadcrumbs, in case someone else finds them and thinks,

"I feel this too."

And in that echo, maybe we're both a little less invisible.